🗓️ Timeline & Cartoons: BASIC Cartoon Handout

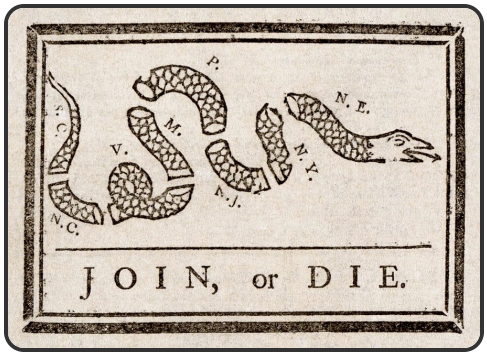
US History · Unit 1 · Level 1 · how to read a political cartoon

Name: _____

🔍 BASIC: 5 steps to read a political cartoon

- **B** 🧠 **Background**: What do I already know about this time?
- **A** 💬 **Argument**: What is the artist's message?
- **S** 🦅 **Symbols**: What do the pictures stand for?
- **I** 🔤 **Indicators**: What do the words and labels say?
- **C** 🏷️ **Caricature**: What is drawn too big on purpose?

🖼️ Practice: Join, or Die



"Join, or Die." Benjamin Franklin, 1754 (public domain)

🧠 **Background:** In 1754 the colonies were about to fight France. Ben Franklin wanted them to work together.

1. 🐍 S: The snake is cut into pieces. The pieces are the…

- 🏘️ **colonies**
- 🍕 **pizza slices**

2. 🔤 I: The words under the snake say…

- 🤝 Join, or Die
- 🎉 Happy Birthday

3. 💬 A: What is the message?

- 🐍 Snakes are scary
- 🤝 Work together or lose

✅ Check

4. 🦅 A symbol is a picture that…

- 🎨 has lots of colors
- 💡 stands for an idea

5. 🎩 Uncle Sam is a symbol for…

- 🇺🇸 the United States
- 🇫🇷 France

6. 📰 Political cartoons are found on the…

- 🏈 sports page
- 📰 opinion page